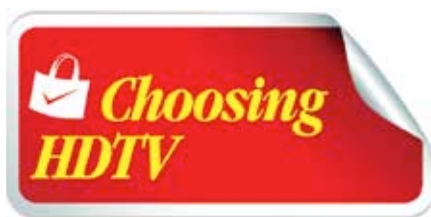


Mall Buying Mantra

Your next purchase shouldn't be a matter of eeny, meeny, miney, mo. Here are some things to check before you buy on the spot

Team Digit
readersletters@thinkdigit.com

When you're in a mall trying to decide on your next big television purchase, it's an important moment that you just have to get right. You don't want to be the person who comes away having bought a lemon, do you? Here are some tips that will help you make a smart buying decision this Diwali and ensure that you get the best value for your money.



Research

1. Reality check: Do you really need an HDTV? It's an important question to ask yourself. Are you ready to invest in

an HDTV without having enough HD content to view on it? The government's cable digitization act will come into effect at the end of the month, but only in the four metros. If you are going to watch only SD content or DVD movies, then there is no point getting an HDTV.

2. Visit HDTV manufacturer's web sites, and also review sites to learn about the latest HDTVs they're selling in the market, how much they cost, etc. Arrive at a rough shortlist of HDTVs you will pick as your ultimate buy (within your budget, of course) before proceeding to the nearest mall to see them live in action.
3. Ascertain the distance at which the TV will be kept from the general viewing area (couch, sofa, bed, etc.). Try to view the content displayed by the TV in the mall from that same distance, don't let the sales attendant influence you in any way in this regard. Go to this link to get

minimum viewing distance for HDTVs of several screen sizes <http://digit.in/PrztGn>.

4. Take a video benchmark disc with you to the electronics store to test your TV's display quality in greater detail. HQV offers a Blu-ray benchmark disc to comprehensively test HDTV screens and their output, read more here: <http://digit.in/S8CHRM>

Observe

1. Mall environments are way brighter than the typical living room's ambient light. If you can arrange for the demo TV to be moved to a darker room (ideally the home entertainment room), great. If you can't, ensure that the light falling on the TVs is evenly distributed – check for empty bulb sockets overhead. This is an attempt to keep ambient light falling evenly on the television sets.
2. Turn off the TV you're interested in buying and observe its screen when it